



BioHackathon series:

[Eurobioc 2026 Hackathon](#)

Turku, Finland, 2023

[Group 1](#)

Submitted: 02 Jun 2026

License:

Authors retain copyright and release the work under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License ([CC-BY](#)).

Published by [BioHackrXiv.org](#)

GPU Access in R

James Dagleish ¹, Sebastian Fischer ², and Nicholas P Cooley ³

¹ Oxford University ² LMU Munich ³ University of Limerick

Introduction

The number of packages in the CRAN archive that are gpu based is 10 out of the total 23797, with most of them defunct and removed from CRAN. GPUMatrix, h2o4gpu, and GeneralizedUmatrixGPU still function while gputools, gpuR, rpud, nmfgpu4R were archived. One package permGPU functions in an OS-specific manner and another nmfgpu4r still actually builds but has warnings. Given the popularity of hardware acceleration outside of academia, and in non-academic settings, this lack of CRAN provided packages can be viewed as perplexing.

Motivation

The inaccessibility of hardware acceleration in the R language has been a missing feature that most R users have been content to live without. The rugged landscape of compute frameworks and hardware providers have also made it difficult for the R community to come together on a paradigm for access that would fit well within R as a language and R as a research ecosystem. Bringing hardware acceleration into R, particularly with CUDA and NVIDIA devices would improve the value of R as a skill for graduates leaving academia, increase the throughput and efficiency of research computing in R, and expand the versatility of R generally.

Results

This hackathon project produced a series of observations about the current state of packages in CRAN that provide access to GPU compute. It leveraged this context to also improve documentation and usability the R packages ACFcuda, and cudatoolkit.

Package	Description
ACFcuda	Basic access to the CUDA api
cudatoolkit	please add a description sebastian!

Meeting information

If you want to submit a preprint to BioHackrXiv, first check if your meeting is registered. You can find a list of meetings [here](#). If your meeting is missing, please contact your meeting organizers. The above list also provides information on the YAML fields with information about the meeting.

The following fields need to be given:

```
biohackathon_name: "BioHackathon Europe 2023"
biohackathon_url:  "https://biohackathon-europe.org/"
biohackathon_location: "Barcelona, Spain, 2023"
group: Project 26
git_url: https://github.com/yourOrganization/your_report_repo
```

The [BioHackrXiv meeting pages](#) provide content to use for the first three fields. The git_url:

field must have the link to the GitHub repository with your preprint (draft).

Author information

Information about the authors is given in the [YAML](#) format at the top of this template. For authors you provide their names, their affiliations. That is the minimum, but as BioHackrXiv is moving to a situation where more metadata is shared, and used by, for example, EuropePMC, adding additional information is encouraged.

BioHackathons is about hacking together, and the minimal number of authors for reports is two. This makes a minimal example look like this:

```
authors:
  - name: First Author
    affiliation: 1
  - name: Last Author
    affiliation: 2
affiliations:
  - name: First Affiliation
    index: 1
  - name: ELIXIR Europe
    index: 2
```

Author identifiers

Ideally, authors provide their [ORCID](#) identifier. For affiliations, it is added with the `orcid:` field. So, an author record would look like this:

```
authors:
  - name: First Author
    affiliation: 1
    orcid: 0000-0000-0000-0000
```

Research Organization Registry identifiers

Matching the author identifier, the affiliations can be further specified with the [Research Organization Registry](#) (ROR) identifier. For example, this is the affiliation identifier can be added with the `ror:` field:

```
affiliations:
  - name: ELIXIR Europe
    ror: 044rwnt51
    index: 2
```

Contributor Role Taxonomy

A last feature since is minimal support for the Contributor Role Taxonomy (CRediT). You can specify the role of authors in writing the report with the `role:` field. However, the authors are responsible for selecting the right terms from [CRediT](#). An example looks like this:

```
authors:
  - name: First Author
    affiliation: 1
    orcid: 0000-0000-0000-0000
    role: Conceptualization, Writing - review & editing
```

A full examples

A full example then has this structure:



```
authors:
- name: First Author
  affiliation: 1
  role: Writing - original draft
- name: Last Author
  orcid: 0000-0000-0000-0000
  affiliation: 2
  role: Conceptualization, Writing - review & editing
affiliations:
- name: First Affiliation
  index: 1
- name: ELIXIR Europe
  ror: 044rwnt51
  index: 2
```

Formatting

This document use Markdown and you can look at [this tutorial](#).

Subsection level 2

Please keep sections to a maximum of only two levels.

Tables

Tables can be added in the following way, though alternatives are possible:

Table: Note that table caption is automatically numbered and should be given before the table itself.

```
| Header 1 | Header 2 |
| ----- | ----- |
| item 1 | item 2 |
| item 3 | item 4 |
```

This gives:

Table 2: Note that table caption is automatically numbered and should be given before the table itself.

Header 1	Header 2
item 1	item 2
item 3	item 4

Figures

A figure is added with:

```
![Caption for BioHackrXiv logo figure](./biohackrxiv.png)
```

This gives:



Figure 1: Caption for BioHackrXiv logo figure

Figures can be scaled by adding the width or height to the Markdown like this:

```
![Caption for BioHackrXiv logo figure](./biohackrxiv.png){ width=50px }
```

Other main section on your manuscript level 1

Lists can be added with:

1. Item 1
2. Item 2

Citation Typing Ontology annotation

You can use [CiTO](#) annotations, as explained in [this BioHackathon Europe 2021 write up](#) and [this CiTO Pilot](#). Using this template, you can cite an article and indicate *why* you cite that article, for instance DisGeNET-RDF (Queralt-Rosinach et al., 2016).

The syntax in Markdown is as follows: a single intention annotation looks like `[@usesMethod In:Krewinkel2017]`; two or more intentions are separated with colons, like `[@extends:discusses:Nielsen2017Scholia]`. When you cite two different articles, you use this syntax: `[@citesAsDataSource:Ammar2022ETL; @citesAsDataSource:Arend2022BioHackEU22]`.

Possible CiTO typing annotation include:

- `citesAsDataSource`: when you point the reader to a source of data which may explain a claim
- `usesDataFrom`: when you reuse somehow (and elaborate on) the data in the cited entity
- `usesMethodIn`
- `citesAsAuthority`
- `citesAsEvidence`
- `citesAsPotentialSolution`
- `citesAsRecommendedReading`
- `citesAsRelated`
- `citesAsSourceDocument`
- `citesForInformation`
- `confirms`
- `documents`
- `providesDataFor`
- `obtainsSupportFrom`
- `discusses`
- `extends`



- agreesWith
- disagreesWith
- updates
- citation: generic citation

Results

Discussion

...

Acknowledgements

...

References

Queralt-Rosinach, N., Pinero, J., Bravo, À., Sanz, F., & Furlong, L. I. (2016). DisGeNET-RDF: harnessing the innovative power of the Semantic Web to explore the genetic basis of diseases. *Bioinformatics*, 32(14), 2236–2238. <https://doi.org/10.1093/bioinformatics/btw214> [cito:citesAsAuthority]

Author contributions

James Dagleish: Author Sebastian Fischer: Author Nicholas P Cooley: Author